capito

IDEM · ITALIAN CORPUS · VERSION 1.4

325 Italian sentences, rewritten in lettura facile

Italian public-information texts aligned with their human-made easy-to-read versions at A2 level, annotated with the lettura facile criteria that produced them.

idem_corpus_it_v1.4.json · 5 November 2026 · simplified by capito

16 source documents from 10 websites	**101** texts, IT_001 to IT_101	**325** original sentences (alignments)
718 simplified entries, 234 of them bullet points	**9,051** words in the originals	**31** lettura facile criteria codes in use

WHAT IT IS

Lead sentences and bullet points

Each original sentence is paired with its easy-to-read version. Shorter sentences stay one entry; longer ones become a lead sentence followed by bullet points, on average **2.2 entries** and up to 14. Entries have **14.7 words** against **27.8** for an original sentence, and the texts grow slightly, to **116%**.

Annotated per alignment

The criteria describe the whole alignment, **6.9 codes** on average, and are repeated on every entry. All entries mark which parts of the original were hard, and 41 alignments carry review notes, including 14 with grammar or word-choice errors.

SOURCES

EU institutions (europarl.europa.eu, citizens.ec.europa.eu), fact-checking and news sites (pagellapolitica.it, ilpost.it, geopop.it), NGOs (actionaid.it, the disability federation FISH on fishonlus.it and fishets.it, universability.it) and the social security agency INPS. Topics range from EU elections and institutions to referendums, legislative reform, US tariffs, children's rights and disability policy. All are copyright cleared.

The Italian, Spanish and Catalan iDEM corpora are not parallel. Each language has its own catalogue and conventions, so criterion codes must never be compared across languages.

STRUCTURE

Three parts, four levels deep

The file is one JSON object. Metadata and the criteria list sit beside the data; the data itself nests from document down to the single simplified entry.

corpus — object
version, date, source file, change log, notes, counts

criteria — 31 entries
code, description, description_en, group, in_official_catalogue, times_used

documents — 16 entries
the data, see below

document — 16 · e.g. IT_023_027 = texts IT_023 to IT_027
document_id · metadata: source_url, creation_date, characters_without_spaces, corpus_category, text_type, topic, complexity_level, simplification_method, institution, tested_by_user_group, copyright_cleared

text — 101 · e.g. IT_023
text_id · translator_id

alignment — 325 · e.g. IT_023-2 = 2nd sentence of IT_023
alignment_id · **original** · source_row · quality_flags (optional)

simplified — 718 · position 1, 2, 3 …
position · **text** · criteria_codes (the alignment's, repeated) · complex_parts · source_row · quality_flags (optional)

A WORKED EXAMPLE

Alignment IT_023-2

ORIGINAL

Eppure milioni di bambini nel mondo continuano a vedersi negati diritti fondamentali come la salute, l'istruzione, un'infanzia serena, un futuro sicuro.

SIMPLIFIED · POSITION · TEXT

1	Ma ancora oggi, milioni di bambini nel mondo non hanno i diritti più importanti. Per esempio:
2	* la salute
3	* andare a scuola
4	* un'infanzia felice
5	* un futuro sicuro

criteria for the whole alignment: 2 4 5 8 10 11 33

*Read the entries in position order: a lead sentence, then bullet points marked with *. The same codes sit on all five entries, but they describe the alignment once: 4 = colon before a list, 33 = bullet points, 5, 8, 10 = common verbs, adjectives and nouns.*

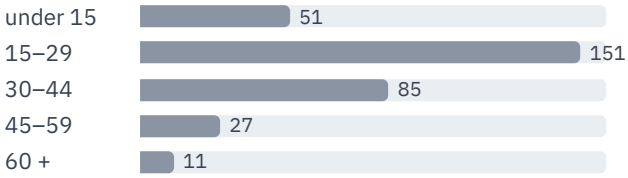
SENTENCES

Long sentences become lists

Original sentences have mostly 15 to 44 words. Simplified entries are shorter, but many still hold two short sentences, so their length varies widely.

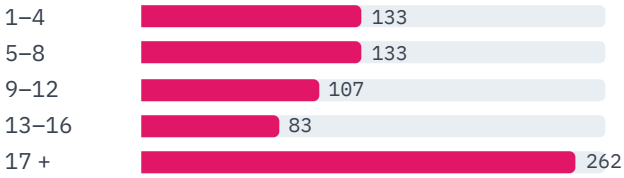
Words per original sentence

Number of alignments, n = 325



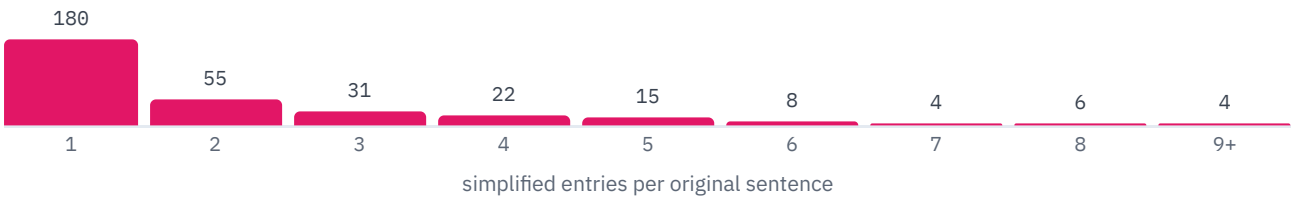
Words per simplified entry

Number of entries, n = 718



How many entries does one original sentence become?

Number of alignments by count of simplified entries

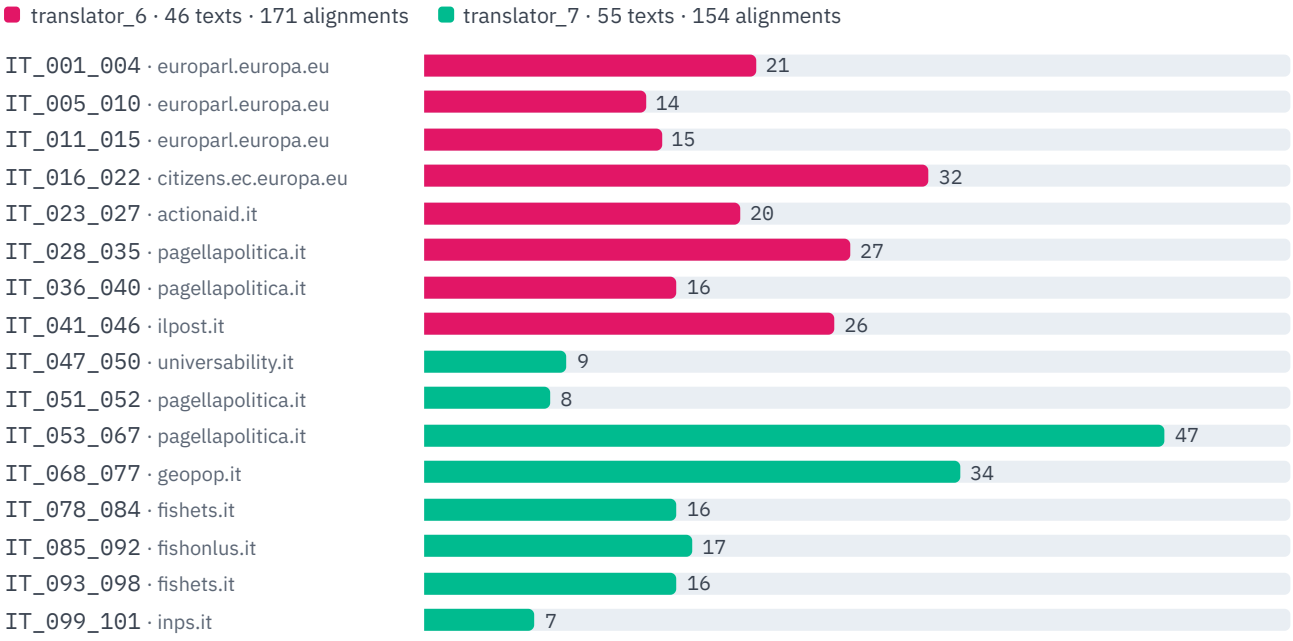


180 sentences are simplified as a single entry. The others are split, usually into a lead sentence and bullet points; 4 alignments have nine or more entries.

DOCUMENTS

A wide mix of sources

Alignments per document, by translator



IT_053_067 (pagellapolitica.it, on the "Taglia leggi" law) is the largest document with 47 alignments. translator_6 simplified the first half of the corpus, translator_7 the second.

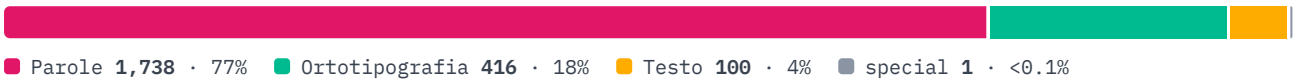
CRITERIA

Common words in almost every sentence

The Italian catalogue has codes 1–33 plus **0** (sentence kept unchanged) and **00** (explanation). This corpus uses 31 of them; codes 1, 13, 25 and 00 never occur. Counted once per alignment, 2,255 codes are applied.

Criteria used, by group

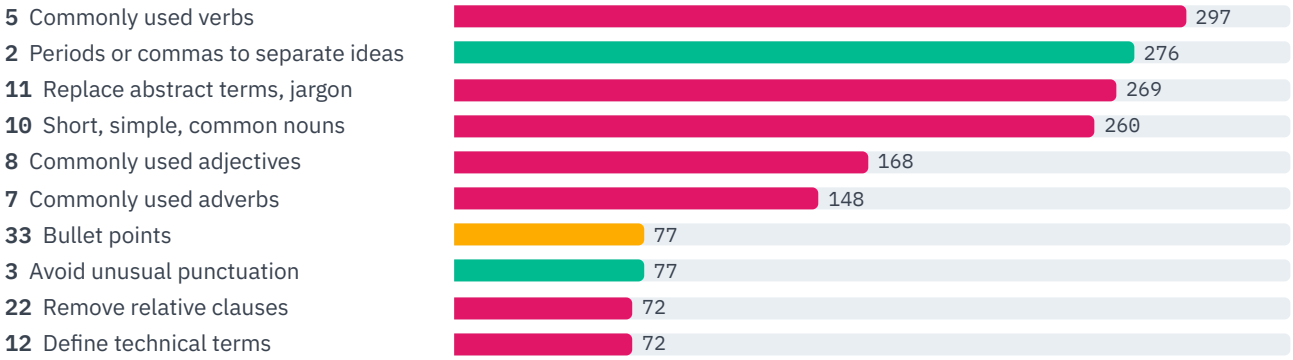
Share of all 2,255 codes, counted once per alignment



Parole **1,738** · 77% Ortotipografia **416** · 18% Testo **100** · 4% special **1** · <0.1%

The ten most used criteria

Number of alignments with the code, out of 325, coloured by group



Codes 5, 2, 11 and 10 appear in more than 80% of alignments: they describe the basic method rather than telling sentences apart. Note that the times_used field in the JSON counts per entry and is inflated; for code 33 it reads 352 against 77 alignments.

Defining terms makes texts longer

Length of the simplification as a share of the original, mean per alignment



QUALITY

Review notes

41 of 325 alignments carry review flags. 14 record grammar or word-choice errors in the simplified text, such as *Il Parlamento europea* or *dipende di*. These are documented, not corrected.

Version 1.4

One spelling error corrected: *realità* became *realtà* (IT_053-1). A full spell check found no other spelling errors in the simplified texts. Original texts are unchanged.

USING IT

Reading the corpus correctly

The Italian file looks like the Spanish one, one entry per line of easy-to-read text, but its criteria belong to the whole alignment.

THINGS TO KNOW WHEN READING IT

POINT	WHAT TO DO
Codes are repeated on every entry	Take them once per alignment, for example from the first entry.
`times_used` counts per entry	Recount at alignment level for analyses.
An entry can hold several sentences	Join all entries in `position` order; lines starting with `*` are bullets.
IT_047-1 has no codes	Its source cell read "x", kept in `criteria_unparsed`.
Codes are strings	Look them up in `criteria`; do not cast to integers.

READING IT IN PYTHON

```
import json

corpus = json.load(open("idem_corpus_it_v1.4.json", encoding="utf-8"))

for doc in corpus["documents"]:
    for text in doc["texts"]:
        for al in text["alignments"]:
            entries = sorted(al["simplified"], key=lambda s: s["position"])
            simplified = "\n".join(s["text"] for s in entries)
            codes = entries[0]["criteria_codes"]   # once per alignment
            print(al["alignment_id"], codes, simplified)
```

The full helper script, read_idem_corpus_it.py, and the README sit next to the JSON file.

VERSIONS

VERSION	DATE	CHANGES
1.4	2026-11-05	1 spelling error corrected (*realità* → *realtà*, IT_053-1). Original texts and grammar issues unchanged. The correction carries a `[v1.4]` flag.
1.3	2026-09-25	text_id corrections, criteria entries completed, counts recomputed.

FILES

FILE	CONTENT
idem_corpus_it_v1.4.json	The corpus
README_corpus_it.md	Structure, field reference, statistics and known issues
read_idem_corpus_it.py	Helper functions to load, walk and flatten the corpus into tables
analyse_idem_corpus_it.py	Short exploratory analysis of the corpus
analysis_results_it.txt	The output of the analysis